PassFrame
TUITION

The Grumbly Gnome

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Poetry

Extract (poem) — read it carefully before answering

In a hollow by the bramble tree
there lived a gnome quite grey and grim,
who grumbled at the buzzing bee
and grumbled at the blackbird's hymn.

He grumbled when the sun came up,
he grumbled when the rain came down,
he grumbled at his chipped old cup,
he grumbled at his pointy crown.

But one wet Tuesday, cold and bleak,
a baby mouse got stuck in mud.
The gnome went out (he had to peek)
and pulled her free with a gentle tug.

The mouse squeaked, 'Thank you!' bright and clear,
and curled up snug beside his boot.
The gnome felt something strange, my dear —
a small warm feeling, soft as soot.

He didn't grumble, not that day,
nor any day from that day on.
The gnome had found, in his own way,
a friend to grumble gently upon.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. Where did the gnome live?

2. Name two things the gnome grumbled about in the first two verses.

3. Underline the line that tells you the weather didn't change the gnome's grumbling.

4. Underline 2 examples of repetition in the poem.

5. What does “grumbled” mean as it is used throughout the poem?

6. True or false: the gnome ignored the baby mouse stuck in the mud.

7. Why do you think the poet repeats the word “grumbled” so many times at the start?

8. What happened on the “wet Tuesday” mentioned in the poem?

9. In your own words, explain how the gnome's feelings change by the end of the poem.

10. What does the simile “soft as soot” tell you about the gnome's new feeling?

11. Why do you think the poet chose a mouse, rather than another creature, to change the gnome's mood?

12. Do you think the gnome is a kind character deep down? Use evidence from the poem to explain.